

LISTENING

#27

1 – Listen to a manager leading her first project meeting with a new team. Pay attention to how she assigns the roles, how the team reacts, and how they try to reorganize responsibilities.

ASSIGNING ROLES

1 - What does the man say about the meeting at the beginning?

- a) It's the first time the team is meeting
- b) It's the final meeting before the presentation
- c) It's a client meeting

2 - What is the woman unsure about at first?

- a) The topic of the meeting
- b) Whether to assign roles herself or let the team decide
- c) Who should lead the presentation

3 - What advice does the man give her?

4 - What role does the woman give to Alex?

- a) Lead presenter
- b) Pitch leader
- c) Tech support

5 - Why does she choose Azra to be the lead presenter?

6 - How does Jasmine react to her role?

7 - What complaint does Thiago make?

8 - How do the team members respond to Orla's assignments overall?

9 - What does the manager say when the team starts arguing?

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

A Team's First Meeting

When a new team comes together for the first time, the atmosphere is often a mix of excitement and uncertainty. Everyone wants to do a good job, but people also want to feel their opinions matter. A good team leader knows that assigning roles isn't just about matching skills to tasks — it's about understanding personalities and balancing responsibilities.

For example, some people are natural leaders and like to make decisions quickly. Others prefer to observe, plan carefully, and take on supportive roles. When these personalities meet, conflict can happen. That's why the first team meeting is so important: it sets the tone for how everyone will work together.

In successful teams, communication is open and respectful. Members share ideas and concerns honestly without turning discussions into arguments. A strong leader listens to the team but also knows when to make final decisions. Without clear direction, meetings can easily turn into confusion.

It's also important to recognize everyone's strengths. A person who isn't comfortable presenting might be great at organizing information or creating visuals. Another person might enjoy speaking in public but dislike technical details. When people play to their strengths, they feel valued and motivated.

In the end, teamwork isn't about everyone doing the same thing. It's about working together toward the same goal, even when opinions differ. The most effective teams are those where people trust one another — and trust their leader to guide them fairly.

Comprehension Questions

1. According to the text, why can the first team meeting be difficult?

2. What can happen if the leader doesn't give clear direction?

3. What makes team members feel motivated?

4. Do you like working in teams or alone? Why?

5. How do you think a good leader should handle disagreements?
